Session 9 — Student Activity Worksheet

Practice Session 6 — Economics of Happiness (Globalisation–Localisation)

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Session Learning Outcomes

By the end of this session, you should be able to:

- State the prevailing view about the goal of society shown in the film, and the side-effects of the prevalent world-view.
- Explain why physical connection ("global village") without a global world-view leads to exploitation of people and nature.
- State the essential requirements of a global world-view.
- Decide what to localise and what to globalise (needs of the Body vs mindset / needs of the Self).

How to Engage with this Worksheet

- Whatever is stated here (and in the lecture) is a proposal — do not assume it to be true or false.
- Verify it on your own right, on the basis of your natural acceptance, and validate it in your living.
- Treat each question as a dialogue: first between you and the material, and then within your own Self — between what you are and what you really want to be.

Part A — Key Ideas (Recap)

- 'The Economics of Happiness' is a documentary about the impact of globalisation on Ladakh (a ~20-minute summary; full film by Local Futures).
- We talk of a 'Global Village' — the world connected physically by technology. But what about the mindset? Do we have a global world-view, or is our way of thinking individualistic?
- If our world-view is not global, if our mindset is not one of living in a relationship of mutual fulfilment globally, and our thinking is not for global order, then physical connection leads to the exploitation of people and of nature — globally; and we can observe this today.
- Hence there is a need for a global world-view. Its essential requirements are: (1) recognition of human aspiration, and (2) providing an all-encompassing solution for the fulfilment of human aspiration. We need to decide what to localise and what to globalise.
- Localise: the needs of the Body. Globalise: the mindset — of living in a relationship of mutual fulfilment globally — and the needs of the Self.

Part B — In-Class Activity

Activity 1 — Localise or Globalise?

Based on the deck, mark each item as something to Localise or to Globalise.

Item	Localise / Globalise
Needs of the Body	Localise
Mindset of living in a relationship of mutual fulfilment globally	Globalise
Needs of the Self	Globalise

Activity 2 — Achievements and side-effects

From the film, list the achievements and the side-effects of the prevalent world-view.

- Prevailing view about the goal of society (as shown in the video): _____ Unchecked economic growth, technological expansion, and globalized consumerism. _____
- Achievements of the prevalent world-view: _____ High-speed communication, global trade networks, and technological convenience. _____
- Side-effects of the prevalent world-view: _____ Environmental degradation, loss of local culture, community breakdown, inequality, and human exploitation. _____

Part C — Long-Answer Questions

Answer in your own words, verifying each point on the basis of your natural acceptance.

Q1. According to the film, what is the prevailing view about the goal of society, and what are some achievements and side-effects of this world-view? **[5]**

The prevailing view prioritizes continuous material accumulation and economic expansion as society's primary goal. While it has produced technological advancements, its side-effects include cultural erosion, environmental damage, and personal isolation.

Q2. Why does physical connection through technology (“global village”) lead to exploitation of people and nature when the world-view is not global? **[5]**

Physical connection without a global world-view creates a system where technology and trade extract resources and exploit communities for individual or corporate gain, lacking an overarching framework of mutual fulfillment.

Q3. What are the two essential requirements of a global world-view? **[5]**

The two essential requirements are: (1) Correct recognition of universal human aspirations, and (2) Providing an all-encompassing framework/solution to fulfill those aspirations globally.

Q4. What does the deck propose we localise and what we globalise, and why? **[5]**

The proposal is to **localise physical needs** (sourcing food, goods, and production locally to reduce environmental impact) and **globalise consciousness/mindset** (sharing wisdom, values, and mutual fulfillment globally).

Q5. Is there a solution to present-day problems? Give your view based on the film and the localise/globalise idea. **[5]**

Present-day problems can be addressed by localizing material production to reduce resource strain while globalizing mutual understanding and values to ensure technological progress serves human well-being.

Self-Reflection (Take-Home)

- Is your own way of thinking global (for mutual fulfilment) or individualistic? Give one example. (Slide 4)
- In your own life, what would you choose to localise and what to globalise? (Slide 6)

Prepared strictly from the lecture/practice-session slides (PS6). UHV-II, Module 2 — Harmony in the Human Being.